

Greatsword vs Longsword, for dummies

Monster Hunter Stories 3: Twisted Reflection

PC



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StormKnightSera

4 months ago

#1

My experience with Monster Hunter boils down to 240 hours in Wilds and that's it. I could ascertain how weapons function pretty quickly in a real-time environment, even just using their combos against the training dummy. Not master them, obviously, but get a basic sense of their purpose. MH Stories is an RPG, though, and this game is asking different things of me.

Certain weapons remain clear in their functionality - Hunting Horns are still Hunting Horns, and thus provide buffs. Hammers break bodies. Bow can debuff, Gunlance can provide Guard. But what is the gameplay difference between Greatswords and Longswords? Early on, I see that they both deal damage and inflict similar levels of Wyvernfell. Is it as simple as "Greatsword = one big cut, Longsword = death by a 1000 cuts"? Does the Longsword's

Board games, card games, video games; I enjoy them all, from Zelda to Borderlands, Battletech to Elden Ring, and beyond. That is, when I'm not overly depressed.

YoukaiSlayer ▼ 4 months ago

#2

Longsword has more team synergy with lunge stance and retaliation stance. Thus it also has potential for way more wyvernfell. Hammer is more for wyvernfell than part breaking btw, which is only influenced by damage dealt for the most part. It's worth noting that shelling with a gunlance has priority which is great if you just need one hit for the topple.

Frankly I never found any reason to use greatsword. The player characters role is not to deal damage and thats all the greatsword does. Longsword offers you the utility of crit eye on spirit release and allows for 4 attacks per turn with lunge stance to really whittle down the wyvernfell gauge in a more stam effective way than hammer.

Worth noting that hammer actually has the strongest guard, with backlash...something, I forget the exact name. Gunlance has a very important move called derring guard which gives you "brace". It doesn't really mention this but that stops you from dying to direct damage for the turn. Invaluable for surviving AoEs and typeless skills for the relatively low cost of 40 stam.

I'm ninja
(you can't see me)

Mcoleya ▼ 4 months ago

#3

I just want to say it's kind of funny that in any other game series 240 hours in one of the entries would make you an expert. But with monster hunter you still feel like a noob. Not throwing shade, I completely agree with you, just wanted to point out the funny though.

StormKnightSera ▼ (Topic Creator) 4 months ago

#4

Would it stand to reason that I should switch Eleanor off of her Greatsword upon unlocking the Hammer? She **wants** to inflict damage, though, so maybe it's not the same situation with her.

I literally just acquired her Hammer so I was curious; "Backlash Blitz" is the name of the aforementioned skill, by the by.

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It's fine to have her on either. As you mentioned, she does want to do damage. On the other hand, wyvernfell damage is generally more useful than actual damage so hammer might be optimal in some cases. On the other other hand, if you want utility from your ally, you probably want someone other than eleanor anyway.

I'm ninja
(you can't see me)

StormKnightSera ▼ (Topic Creator) 4 months ago

#6

I forgot to mention it but I switched off the Greatsword for the Longsword, and I'm really enjoying it! It's a lot more fun to play with, and I can already see how effective it can be.

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